



**1906**

was the year when freedom fighter Rash Behari Bose joined FRI as a clerk but was removed in 1914 for absenteeism. He was on leave from November 25 to December 31, 1912, when a bomb was thrown on Viceroy Lord Hardinge in Delhi.

**"The FRI has significantly contributed to research right from basic forestry to advanced studies like biotechnology and biofuels."** S.S. NEGI, DIRECTOR, FRI

**NATURAL PURSUIT: Scholars on the campus**

Located on a sylvan 1,200-acre wooded campus in Dehra Dun, it is a gigantic vault that holds all the data about India's forest wealth, past and present. The FRI's xylarium is a library of 20,000 wood specimens of trees from around the world. The 3.3-lakh plant specimens, some over two centuries old, form among Asia's largest herbariums, and its collection of two lakh forest insects are among the largest in the world. Nowhere in the world are all 13 disciplines of forestry—from genetics and tree propagation to forest pathology—housed under one roof, a splendid Greco-Roman structure. Declared a university 17 years ago, it is a hub of

education which churns out nearly 130 scholars as also the forest officers and rangers, from its forest academy, who protect it. "The FRI has contributed to research in forestry and environment, from basic forestry knowledge and technology, to advanced studies in frontline thrust areas like biotechnology, biofuels and nano forestry," says FRI Director S.S. Negi. At a time when the twin threats of global warming and fast depleting fossil fuels occupy maximum bandwidth, the institute is assured of a relevance that runs parallel to the wealth it studies.

**by Sandeep Unnithan**